



Going forward:

Continuing professional
development for ESOL
teachers in the UK



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esol.britishcouncil.org

INTRODUCTION

So you're working in ESOL¹ teaching and want to find the best ways to develop. But how do you progress as an ESOL teacher?? What career pathways are open for you? What can you do to help you develop your skills and prospects? Where can you find the support to help you?

These are some of the questions this handbook aims to answer.

The term 'teacher' includes those working, for example, as volunteers, teachers, lecturers, tutors, trainers and co-ordinators in publicly-funded adult ESOL provision (including 14–19 provision). ESOL teachers, as with other teachers in the learning and skills sector, are often referred to as 'dual professionals': they are both 'subject specialists' (ESOL) and professional teachers. Job titles may vary but ESOL practitioners work with a wide range of learners with English language needs and in a variety of settings, for example, in colleges, in work-based learning providers, in adult and community learning, in the Ministry of Defence/armed services, in prisons and probation centres, in voluntary organisations and in the workplace.

This handbook provides information to help you develop, whether you are starting out as a new teacher, or are already highly experienced. At every stage of your career there are always opportunities to develop your skills, knowledge and prospects further.

Each of the four nations of the UK has its own inspectorate which regulates and inspects publicly-funded learning and skills provision, including ESOL. In an inspection, inspectors regularly evaluate the quality of provision and require details of qualifications and CPD activities carried out by staff. For information about the four inspectorates, go to

England:	www.ofsted.gov.uk
Scotland:	www.hmie.gov.uk
Wales:	www.estyn.gov.uk
Northern Ireland:	www.etini.gov.uk

The information here is based on the principle that the effective teacher is the developing teacher: it is never possible to effectively stand still in your work as an ESOL practitioner. Continuing professional development is a process that helps teachers and managers meet the challenges of their work and achieve their own and their organisation's goals. It incorporates the idea of 'reflective practice' – the importance of reflecting on what you are doing – as an essential part of the development process.

There is a companion handbook for managers. Information for teachers and managers is also available on the British Council's ESOL NEXUS CPD portal <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/teacher-development>

**This handbook was put together by:
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based on an original document by Tim Phillips**

1. English for Speakers of Other Languages

2. The term 'teacher' is used to refer to anyone who is responsible for planning and carrying out teaching or learning delivery with a learner or learners – regardless of the number of hours they work, their job title or work context.

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WHY CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT?

I've been teaching ESOL for 15 years now. I love the job and want to keep doing it, but I need to find some fresh inspiration.

I've just finished my CELTA course and started my first job. Some of the learners have very low literacy levels – I really need some guidance on how to work with them.

I've just started as an ESOL co-ordinator in an adult learning centre and am finding it quite a challenge. I've been teaching ESOL for eight years and thought I knew about ESOL provision, but now I realise there's a lot I need to find out about, like funding and targets, and how to fit in the admin!

I'm an ESOL manager/teacher at a training provider and I'd like to improve some of the skills I need for my job, particularly IT and e-learning.

I've been teaching for four years, mostly to adults in the community. Now my manager has asked me to teach 16–18's in college. Help! How can I develop my skills?

I've been teaching for a couple of years and now I'm just starting a new job teaching ESOL in a prison. I've never taught in a prison before and I'd really like to meet other ESOL teachers working in the same situation.

WHAT IS CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT (CPD)?

‘Continuing professional development (CPD) is the process which ensures that all educational staff can, at all stages of their careers, develop their knowledge, improve their skills and enhance their confidence and motivation to affect ... learning positively.’

www.cpdscotland.org.uk/about/aboutcpd/index.asp

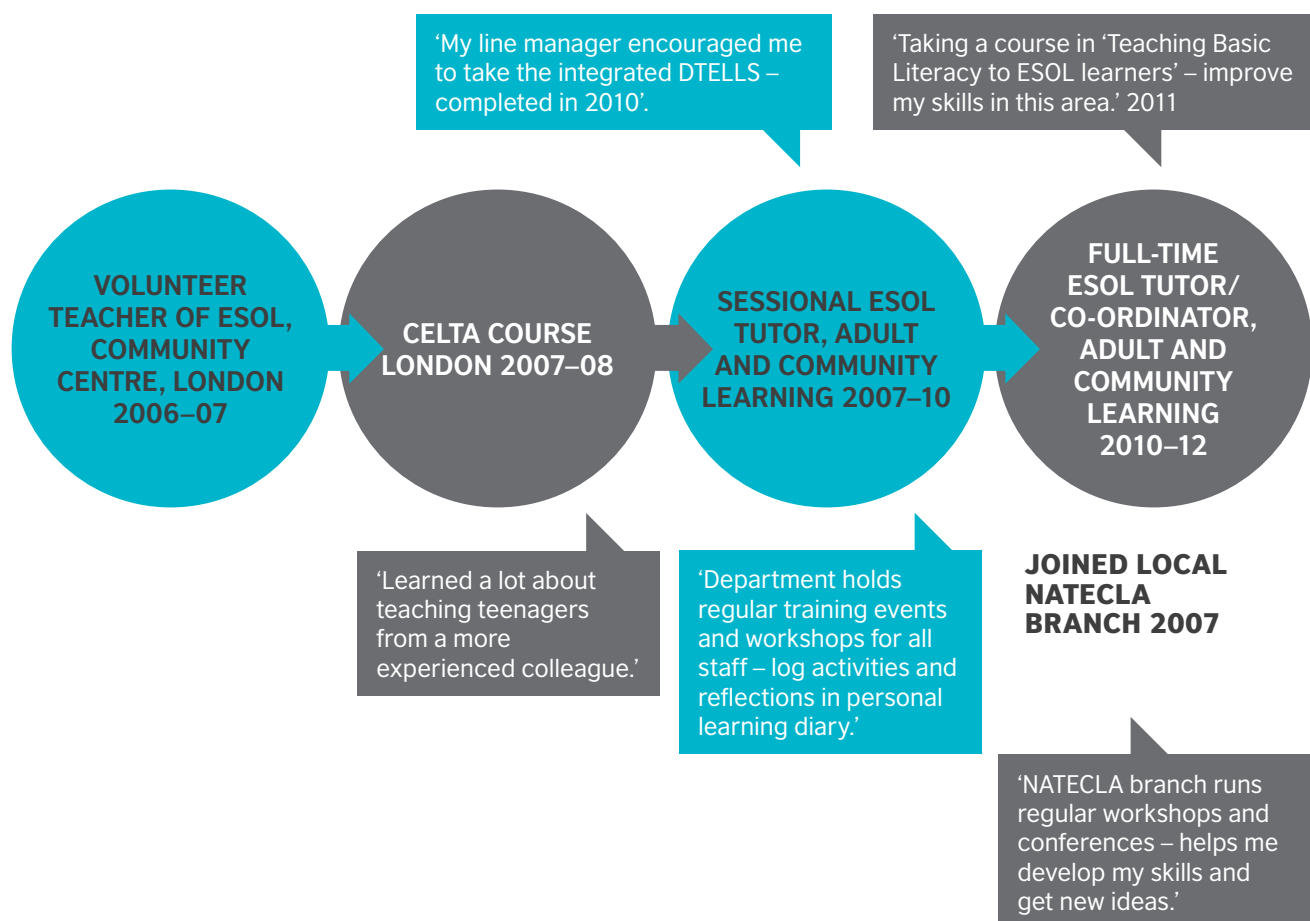
Key characteristics are that it is:

- continuous – professionals should always be looking for ways to deal with new challenges and improve performance
- personalised – the individual identifies his/her own needs and how to meet those needs.

- critically reflected upon – the individual demonstrates that learning experiences and activities are meaningful, effective and improve practice.
- formal (e.g. attending conferences or workshops) or informal (e.g. reading journal articles or reviewing websites).
- an integral part of professional life.

Here is an example of how one teacher, Anna, has managed some of her CPD in her first few years of teaching. It shows the different jobs she's had as an ESOL teacher, some of the CPD activity she's done at different stages of her career, and her notes on how she benefited from her CPD activity:

REGULAR PROGRAMME OF CPD ACTIVITIES



An effective CPD policy and system gives staff opportunities to develop and meet their own and the organisation's requirements. It helps create a sense of belonging to the organisation, helps you build professional relationships, sharing and learning from colleagues and peers, and it helps managers to identify effective development opportunities to meet the individual needs of each teacher. To be effective, CPD should take place at all the stages of a teacher's career. At each stage there are common needs in meeting the challenges of the work you are doing and in going forward. You will also have personal objectives you want to achieve

Different perspectives on CPD

It is important to be aware of different approaches to CPD, to consider the best ways of enhancing your professionalism and to identify meaningful, effective and leading-edge development opportunities. All places of learning are unique and located in their own context and workplace culture: you may find that your organisation holds regular development days at which all staff are required to attend generic, 'packaged' CPD events which your organisation deems important for your practice; on the other hand, if you work for a large organisation, there may be a dedicated staff development centre which offers teachers opportunities to shape their own development as professionals.

TYPES OF CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITY



CPD can be transformative and personalised, teacher-led and self-differentiated, and teachers can form 'communities of practice' to work collaboratively, for example, on action research projects.

The main areas of activity are:

- developing a reflective approach to practice
- expanding and enhancing your skills
- updating your knowledge

These areas are supported through:

- critical reflection on practice
- reading and critical review of resources
- collaboration (sharing and learning) with peers
- participation in further training (for example, workshops, courses)

You may find the suggestions and resources provided in this section useful in supporting your own professional development.

General resources for CPD

This section contains a selection of resources which provide information and guidance on activities for professional development planning, including support for teacher training.

ESOL Nexus website and CPD Framework:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/teachers>

The *Excellence Gateway* website has many examples of activities and approaches for CPD activities:
<http://tlp.excellencegateway.org.uk/tlp/top/professional-development.html>

CPD Scotland:
www.cpdscotland.org.uk/index.asp

The *Learning and Skills Improvement Service* (LSIS) offers a wide range of training events for those working in the Lifelong Learning sector in England, including ESOL teachers. Details can be found at:
www.lsis.org.uk/Pages/default.aspx

Institute for Learning (IfL) is the professional body for teachers, trainers, tutors and student teachers in the further education, learning and skills sector in England. It has extensive information on CPD.

www.ifl.ac.uk

Continuing Professional Development in the Lifelong Learning Sector by Peter Scales, Jo Pickering, Lynn Senior, Kath Headley, Patsy Garner and Helen Boulton, published by Open University Press (2010)

Just suppose teaching and learning became the first priority by Frank Coffield, published by Learning and Skills Network, London (2008)

Improving Learning Cultures in Further Education by D James and G Biesta, published by Routledge, London (2007)

Materials for teaching/learning ESOL

This section contains links to some useful websites for materials and resources for teaching ESOL.

The *Excellence Gateway* provides access to many ESOL resources developed as part of the *Skills for Life* strategy such as the Adult ESOL Core Curriculum, ESOL Teaching and Learning materials, Citizenship materials (England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland packs), ESOL materials for Migrant Workers, resources for assessment, etc:

www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/1193

ESOL Scotland has a databank of useful resources:
www.esolscotland.com/esol/databanknew.cfm

The Scottish *ESOL Curriculum Framework*:
www.educationscotland.gov.uk/communitylearninganddevelopment/adultlearning/ESOL/framework/index.asp

UK publishers offer a vast range of resources to support teachers:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/elt-directory/publishers

Trying out or designing teaching materials is a good way of developing that is relevant whatever your level of experience. There are teaching ideas in published books and on websites, such as:

<http://esol.britishcouncil.org>

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/try

www.esolscotland.com/databankresources.cfm

www.esolvideos.co.uk

www.usingenglish.com

www.skillsworkshop.org/esol

www.bbc.co.uk/worldservice/learningenglish

www.talent.ac.uk/dsearch.asp

Magazines and journals

Subscribing to a magazine or journal is a good way to keep up-to-date with new ideas and themes in ESOL. NATECLA News and Language Issues, the journal of NATECLA, can be obtained directly from NATECLA:

www.natecla.org.uk/content.asp?CategoryID=469

Most magazines and journals are available online as well in hard-copy:

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/elt-directory/journals

Reflection

'The teacher's ability to reflect on his or her own practice can be an important driving force to bring about change and improvement. For example, when teachers enter the classroom, they bring with them not just their teaching skills, but also their own experience, perceptions and cultural assumptions of learning.'

Schellekens, P (2007) *The Oxford ESOL Handbook*

The ability to reflect on your own practice is an essential skill for all teachers, articulating strengths and weaknesses, and identifying ways to improve.

Articles on developing skills as a reflective practitioner:
www.teachingenglish.org.uk/think/articles/reflective-teaching-exploring-our-own-classroom-practice

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/articles/reflective-teaching-exploring-our-own-classroom-practice

<http://archive.excellencegateway.org.uk/page.aspx?o=319323>

Mentoring and coaching

Mentoring involves a partnership between a more skilled or experienced person and someone less skilled or experienced. The mutually agreed goal is to help the less skilled person to develop their work-related skills, knowledge and understanding. The relationship is based on the development of skills, confidence and competence and is often referred to as a 'learning conversation'. Mentoring can be a very effective tool for supporting the induction of a new member of staff and is a good developmental activity for an experienced teacher.

Coaching has been defined as '*unlocking a person's potential to maximise their own performance. It is helping them to learn rather than teaching them.*'³ In peer coaching, two or more colleagues work together to reflect on their practice, share ideas and develop new skills, perhaps conducting action research or problem solving within the workplace, and learning from one another.

There is more about mentoring and coaching on the Excellence Gateway:

Mentoring:

www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/17227

A Mentor Guidance document can be downloaded from:

www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/17350

An introduction to coaching:

www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/12643

Observation

Being observed and getting feedback from a supportive colleague can give a fresh perspective on teaching and help identify areas for development.

Articles on how to make observation work:

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/articles/peer-observation

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/think/articles/peer-observation

Teaching and learning: quality and observation:

<http://www.excellencegateway.org.uk/node/1469>

Research

Small-scale classroom action research can help in finding out more about classroom and learning processes and so develop your professional understanding and skills.

For more information:

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/articles/action-research

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/blogs/virdian/classroom-action-research-a-professional-development-process

The National Research and Development Centre for Adult Literacy and Numeracy (NRDC) has published many research reports on ESOL, Literacy and Numeracy in England and Wales:

www.nrdc.org.uk/content.asp?CategoryID=422

ESOL Scotland has information and links on ESOL research:

www.esolscotland.com/research.cfm

An evaluation of ESOL in the post-compulsory learning and skills sector:

www.ofsted.gov.uk/resources/esol-post-compulsory-learning-and-skills-sector-evaluation

3. Whitmore, J (2003) 3rd Ed. *Coaching for Performance: Growing People, Performance and Purpose*. Nicholas Brearley Publishing: London

Networking, groups and associations

A good way for ESOL teachers to develop is to participate in conferences, seminars and workshops. Here, you can meet and talk to colleagues, gain new ideas, reflect on practice, develop your professional judgement and expertise and learn from one another. More experienced and confident teachers can also benefit from giving their own presentations as a way to share experience with other teachers and for their own professional development.

Professional associations offer a range of development activities, including conferences, journals, special interest groups, research activities and projects.

Networking with other teachers is one of the most stimulating ways to develop and there are many ESOL/ELT Facebook and Twitter groups for English language teachers.

The UK organisation for all teachers of ESOL is the National Association for Teaching English and Community Languages to Adults (NATECLA) which has a major conference in the UK every year. The association offers networking and training opportunities through its branches, conferences, working groups and online groups, including Facebook and Twitter:
www.natecla.org.uk
<http://twitter.com/#!/NATECLA>

The Northern Association of Teachers of English to Speakers of Other Languages (NATESOL) is based in Manchester and holds six teacher-development sessions a year, including a full day's conference in June.
www.natesol.org

ESOL Scotland has an ESOL Practitioners' Network and ESOL E-News:
www.esolscotland.com/esolnetwork.cfm

Other development opportunities include seminars and courses:
www.esolscotland.com/profdevopps.cfm

The International Association of Teachers of English as a Foreign Language (IATEFL) has an ESOL 'Special Interest Group' (ESOLSIG) and has a major conference in the UK every year.

www.iatefl.org

British Council seminars take place around the UK and are often videoed and made available on the Teaching English website.

www.teachingenglish.org.uk/seminars

ESOL-Research is a forum for researchers and practitioners with an interest in research into teaching and learning ESOL. ESOL-Research is managed by James Simpson at the Centre for Language Education Research, School of Education, University of Leeds.

To join, visit:

www.jiscmail.ac.uk/lists/ESOL-RESEARCH.html

The National Institute of Adult Continuing Education, England and Wales (NIACE) offers a wide range of CPD courses and events.

www.niace.org.uk/campaigns-events/events

Trade Unions

Many unions and union branches have branch learning representatives in colleges and learning providers. These representatives can often help people access CPD opportunities both inside and outside the provider. The main teaching unions are:

UCU (University and College Union)

<http://www.ucu.org.uk>

ATL (Association of Teachers and Lecturers)

www.atl.org.uk/help-and-advice/performance-management/continuing-professional-development.asp

NASUWT

www.nasuwt.org.uk/MemberSupport/TeacherGroups/FurtherEducationTeacher/index.htm

EIS-FELA (Educational Institute of Scotland Further Education Lecturers Association)

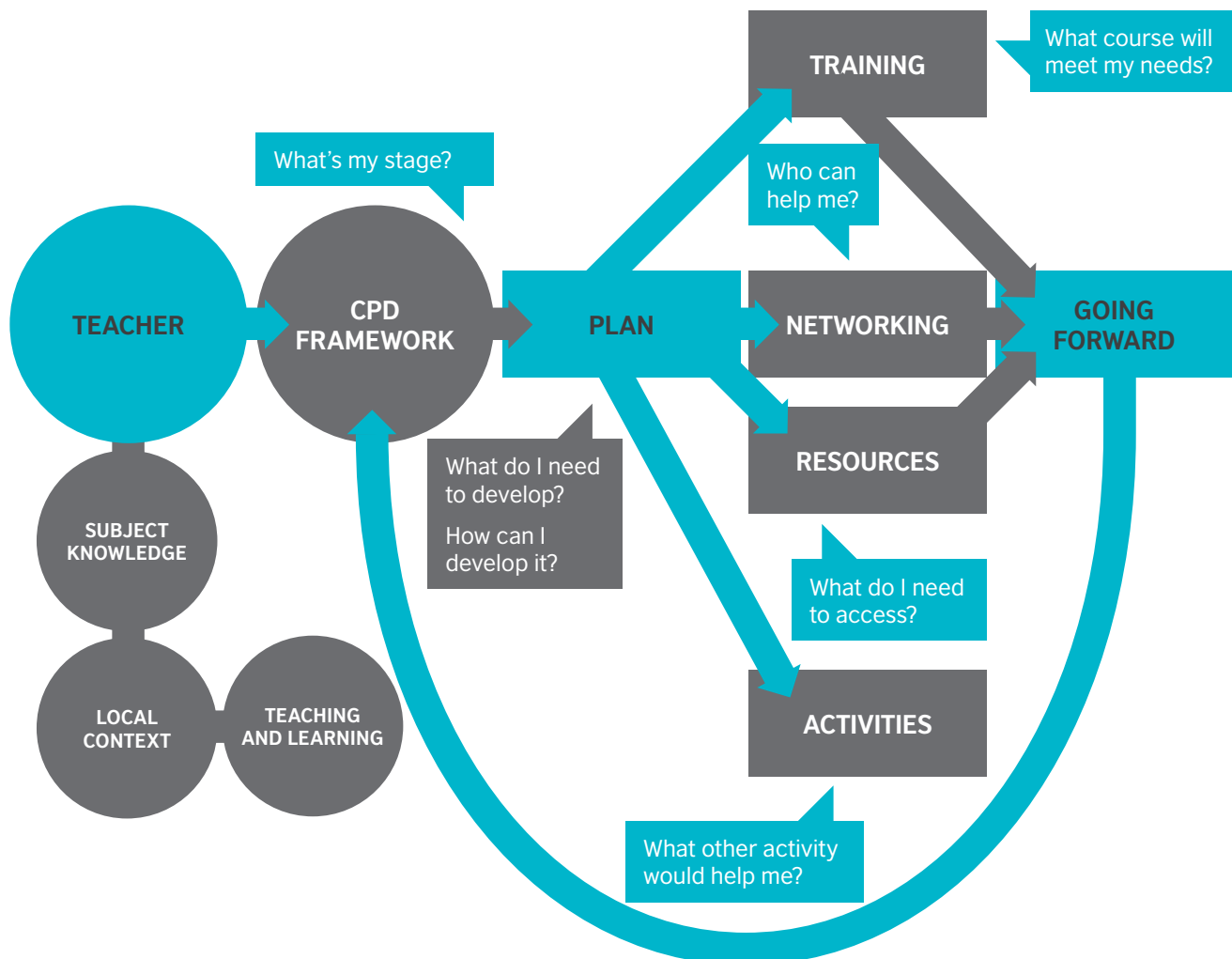
www.eis.org.uk/public.asp?id=273&Parentid=1

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

An important part of CPD is having a recognised framework of stages and pathways through which you can progress. The British Council framework is presented on the next few pages. It is important to note that although the framework provides you with suggested pathways for professional development, the stages are not necessarily sequential and elements from one stage may well overlap with another.

Using the framework is part of a cycle of reflective practice. You can identify the stage you are at and compare your skills, behaviour and knowledge to those represented in the framework. In this way, you can assess your strengths and areas for development and find professional development opportunities which help you to address your needs and meet the diverse challenges you may face in teaching ESOL.

The process can be represented in this way:



THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK

This is our framework of stages of an ESOL teacher's career.

It provides a useful way to identify which stage you are at.

Stages			
Novice teachers	1 Starting	Learning the principles of teaching and understanding the ESOL context	You've just started teaching ESOL and may be on a training course.
	2 Newly qualified	First steps to gaining experience and developing teaching skills	You have a recognised initial TESOL qualification (or teaching qualification) and are in your first couple of years teaching ESOL.
Teachers with experience	3 Developing	Building teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	You have a few years' experience and are consolidating your subject knowledge and teaching skills, and deepening your understanding of the potential needs of ESOL learners.
	4 Proficient	Demonstrating consistently good teaching skills, experience and reflection	You are an experienced ESOL teacher with evidence of further training, and you keep up-to-date with developments in the field. You may have wider responsibilities, for example as a curriculum manager.
Teachers progressing into more advanced roles	5 Advanced	Demonstrating excellent teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	You are a highly-experienced ESOL teacher who may be taking on further responsibilities and a specialist role, e.g. as a mentor or external examiner.
	6 Specialist	Leading and advising	You are a sector expert who advises on policy and practice and you may have a specialist role, for example as a manager or materials writer.

The following pages provide more detailed information about the different stages of the framework and the areas in which you may wish to develop at each stage.

Please refer to the document 'Continuing professional development framework for teachers of ESOL Routes to excellence' for more information about the stages.

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK STAGE 1

Stage 1 – Starting – Learning the principles of teaching and understanding the ESOL context	
At this stage you will have some of these characteristics	• You've just started teaching ESOL in the UK and may be on a training course. • You are not yet qualified as an ESOL teacher. • You are working as a volunteer ESOL tutor. • You have limited ESOL teaching experience so far. • You have school teaching experience and are moving into the ESOL sector.
You may have some of these needs	• Build confidence in your own knowledge of the English language. • Understand the diverse nature of the ESOL sector in the UK, ESOL learners and the ESOL curriculum. • Achieve an initial ESOL teaching qualification. • Watch examples of good teaching. • Complete course assignments as part of your training course. • Find teaching practice.
How you progress at this stage	At this early stage of your career, you will progress by: • Learning about the diverse needs of ESOL learners in the UK and the range of ESOL provision. • Learning about and understanding your organisation's policies on safeguarding, equality and diversity. • Developing effective strategies and techniques for teaching particular aspects of language by observing other teachers, peer coaching, and by putting what you have learned into practice in the classroom and/or on teaching practice. • Learning about principles and practice in these aspects of English language teaching: • planning lessons and courses • understanding learners • managing the lesson • evaluating and assessing learning • differentiation.
Priority focus for your CPD activity at this stage	• Observe and learn from experienced teachers. • Learn from learners. • Find out what resources are appropriate and where they are available. • Discuss teaching issues and problems with colleagues and experienced teachers. • Keep a professional development journal reflecting on your experiences. • Join a teachers' association such as NATECLA or relevant social networks.
Going forward	• You will pass your initial qualification successfully and find your first job. • Try to take a longer term view: where do you see yourself as a teacher in a number of years? What experience will help you get there? What do you need to do?

Stage 1 – Starting – Learning the principles of teaching and understanding the ESOL context	
Do you show these indications of development at this stage?	• You are enthusiastic, enjoy working with learners and want to succeed. • You seek guidance and input. • You want feedback on your performance and use feedback to improve. • You find appropriate teaching materials and useful articles through e.g. libraries and ESOL websites. • You ask for, share and try out new ideas. • You find out about ESOL provision in your local area. • You keep a journal reflecting on your experiences as you learn to be teacher. • You build an understanding of how you would like to progress in teaching ESOL. • You respond positively to pressures.
Are there areas where you could improve?	• You are reluctant to do more than you are asked. • You rely on what your trainers tell you and don't read widely. • You don't find feedback on your teaching useful and find it difficult to reflect critically. • You don't share your ideas and concerns with colleagues and teachers. • You take a teacher-centred view of the classroom.

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK STAGE 2

Stage 2 – Newly qualified – first steps to gaining experience and teaching skills	
At this stage you have some of these characteristics	• You have an initial qualification in TESOL and are in your first or second year of practice. • You are a recently trained EFL or school teacher with no experience within ESOL contexts. • You work in a particular context such as a training provider, adult/community education or FE college. • You are working towards a nationally-recognised teaching/ESOL qualification.
You may have some of these needs	• Develop your knowledge of English and other languages. • Learn more about specific areas of ESOL such as work-based learning and embedding. • Learn to select and adapt teaching materials effectively, including authentic material and interactive resources. • Plan and deliver a coherent lesson. • Understand the highly diverse nature of ESOL learners and the impact this has on teaching/learning. • Get feedback on your teaching. • Build confidence as a teacher of ESOL. • Develop the ability to reflect on practice.
How you progress at this stage	You progress by consolidating your skills and increasing your knowledge and understanding of ESOL teaching, including: • Focusing more on your learners when lesson planning. • Observing and talking to experienced ESOL teachers. • Seeking help and advice from a supportive mentor or manager. • Managing your time efficiently in planning and classroom management. • Developing skills in assessing learners. • Being open to feedback and constructive criticism. • Being able to reflect on training and teaching experience and using reflection to improve practice. You are developing generic skills such as: • Understanding your organisation's context and goals. • Contributing to the team, including building resources. • Record keeping and IT skills You are also using social networking/blogs to communicate with other ESOL teachers. • You join a teachers' association.

Stage 2 – Newly qualified – first steps to gaining experience and teaching skills	
Priority focus for your CPD activity at this stage	• Learn from more experienced teachers. • Start your own development portfolio to help you reflect on your learning, identify your needs and plan activities to meet them. • Subscribe to an ESOL newsletter or journal.
Going forward	• You show that the skills from your initial teaching qualification have been consolidated, the skills, knowledge and understanding for day-to-day teaching are present, and you are beginning to find your place in the ESOL profession.
Do you show these indications of development at this stage?	• You attend workshops and actively look for ways to develop teaching, including subscribing to blogs and websites. • You ask for, share and try out new ideas. • You view asking for assistance as a positive form of development. • You are enthusiastic and like to talk about your classroom experiences (both positive and negative) with colleagues. • You start your own development portfolio to help you reflect on your learning, identify your needs and plan activities to meet them. • You understand the importance of differentiation and you seek to meet all learners' needs. • You actively develop your own language awareness through reading and using reference books. • You prepare thoroughly before lessons, making sure tasks are appropriate for your learners and achievable at the level you are teaching. • You show sensitivity and cultural awareness. • You understand the importance of good record-keeping. • You show positive signs of professionalism (punctuality, appropriate dress, appropriate behaviour). • You ensure that your role in the organisation supports colleagues. • You get positive feedback from students. • A lot of teaching techniques are becoming 'second nature' to you. • You respond positively to pressures.

Stage 2 – Newly qualified – first steps to gaining experience and teaching skills	
Are there areas where you could improve?	• You are reluctant to attend trainings and workshops. • You teach straight from published course-book/worksheets and are not interested in adapting or creating your own materials. You rely on the teacher's book for answers and ideas. • You struggle when learners ask you questions about grammar or vocabulary. • You don't like to plan lessons. • You overplan by micromanaging classes and don't allow learners to 'talk from within'. • You don't take into account the needs of the students and only teach according to your own preset judgements. • You feel that asking for help is a form of weakness. • You're often late, absent, or inappropriately dressed. • You tend to ignore the importance of administration. • You act independently of others in the organisation/department and don't support their work. • You often get negative feedback from students. • You still struggle with basic teaching techniques and classroom management.

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK STAGE 3

Stage 3 – Developing – building teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	
At this stage you will have some of these characteristics	• You have a few years' experience, are consolidating your subject knowledge and teaching skills, and deepening your understanding of the needs of ESOL learners. • You have taught a variety of learners and levels. • You may have a nationally-recognised teaching/ESOL qualification. • You may be an experienced EFL or school teacher without experience of the ESOL sector.
You may have some of these needs	• Develop a wider range of effective teaching strategies. • Develop your own teaching materials, including interactive resources. • Consolidate knowledge and skills, including awareness of the needs of ESOL learners in a range of sectors. • Develop the ability to differentiate effectively to meet learners' individual needs. • Build on your knowledge of English and other languages. • Reflect on your practice. • Keep up-to-date with developments in the ESOL sector.
How you progress at this stage	You have successfully achieved a recognised initial teaching qualification and have completed your first few years at this stage. You may, however, have taught many more years than this, but recognise that you have a number of professional development needs: • You may need extra training in specific areas. • You may want to participate in more events and network with other teachers. • You may want to find out about more resources and e-learning. • You may need to respond to changes in your department/organisation – new courses, new requirements, new types of learners, new materials. At this stage you are beginning the process of dealing with the issues that arise in mid-career, of sustaining your own development and responding to changes in your context and profession. Your main way of developing at this stage is to undertake further specialist training. You may also need to develop in some of these areas: • Planning regular involvement in CPD. • Ability to reflect and self-analyse. • Organisational skills. • Resource development. • Time management. • Relationship/people management.

Stage 3 – Developing – building teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	
Priority focus for your CPD activity at this stage	• Experiment with new teaching ideas, methods and resources. • Shadow or team-teach with more experienced colleagues. • Undertake peer observations. • Become involved in coaching and mentoring. • Attend conferences, seminars and workshops. • Learn about and develop your own strengths and interests. • Contribute to blogs and ESOL groups.
Going forward	It is likely that you will move onto the next stage when you have completed a full teaching qualification.
Do you show these indications of development at this stage?	• You are positive about ESOL as a career. • You want to gain further qualifications. • You feel comfortable working at a variety of levels and with a wide range of learners and enjoy being challenged in your teaching. • You are interested in research and theory as well the application of theory to practice. • You read and reflect on relevant articles and reports to help you develop further. • You are keen to try new approaches, including e-learning and m-learning. • You differentiate and adapt teaching strategies to better suit your own teaching style and different learning styles to meet learners' needs. • You share materials and lesson plans with colleagues. • You are keen to attend CPD training sessions and workshops. • You use social networking/blogs to communicate with other ESOL professionals. • You are keen to be observed by peers or managers. • You always prepare thoroughly for your lessons, placing the learners' needs at the centre of your planning. • You fully understand your role in the organisation/department. • You are keen to mentor new members of staff. • You cope well with changes to provision as a result of internal or external policy changes. • You receive positive feedback from learners.
Are there areas where you could improve?	• You don't usually prepare thoroughly enough – you rely on the book/worksheet. • You find it difficult to differentiate to meet all learners' needs. • You've reached a plateau and feel you've 'seen it all before'. • You avoid working with certain levels or types of groups that you find challenging. • You rarely seek out new challenges or opportunities for extra responsibility. • You dislike feedback and avoid situations that generate criticism. • You tend to act independently of others in the organisation. • You sometimes get negative feedback from learners. • You find it difficult to adapt to curriculum changes.

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK STAGE 4

Stage 4 – Proficient – demonstrating consistently good teaching skills, experience and reflection	
At this stage you have some of these characteristics	• You are an experienced ESOL teacher with evidence of further training, qualifications, all-round competence, active in keeping up-to-date professionally. • You may have wider responsibilities, for example, curriculum management, enrolment, assessment. • You have strengths in teaching in specialist areas. • You have experience of teaching in different ESOL contexts. • You have a strong understanding of ESOL learners' needs, teaching principles and pedagogical practice. • You are active in your own CPD and look for ways to further consolidate your skills through relevant training and other activities.
You may have some of these needs and goals	You are aiming to continue as a teacher, deepening and expanding your skills. You may, for, example, wish to: • Gain new knowledge and skills through further specialist training. • Develop specialist skills, e.g. mentoring of colleagues. • Learn how to create teaching and learning materials for use by others. • Improve the quality of teaching and learning through innovative practice. • Reflect more deeply on teaching and learning.
How you progress at this stage	You may need to develop your skills in these areas: • Management skills. • Interpersonal skills. • Administrative skills. • Self-awareness and reflection. • Coaching and mentoring skills – working with less-experienced teachers. • Running CPD sessions. • Becoming actively involved in a teachers' association or group.
Priority focus for your CPD activity at this stage	• Further develop your expertise and specialisation. • Keep up to date with new developments in ESOL sector. • Read and reflect on articles in professional journals to help you develop further. • Follow your career path, getting experience and qualifications, into an ESOL specialist role.
Going forward	You move on to the next stage when you demonstrate competence and skill as an ESOL professional and are ready to take on a senior and/or specialist role.

Stage 4 – Proficient – demonstrating consistently good teaching skills, experience and reflection	
Do you show these indications of development at this stage?	• You welcome more variety and seek challenges. • You are keen to improve the quality of teaching and learning through innovative practice. • You are motivated by teaching others. • You want to get involved in new projects and undertake action research. • You respond well to curriculum changes resulting from internal or external policies. • You view teaching on a macro level. • You show you are a reflective practitioner. • You offer constructive and sensitive feedback in peer observation. • You respond to feedback on your teaching and use it to improve. • You are actively involved in a teachers' association, group or blog.
Are there areas where you could improve?	Consider whether there are areas that could be improved, such as your ability to reflect effectively on your teaching. You may find that you are reluctant to take risks and seek out challenging opportunities for fear of failure.

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK STAGE 5

Stage 5 – Advanced – demonstrating excellent teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	
At this stage you will have some of these characteristics	• You are a highly experienced ESOL teacher who is capable of advising other teachers on the quality of their teaching. • You may have a TESOL Diploma and/or Master's level qualification. • You may have wider responsibilities and a specialist role, e.g. mentoring other teachers, working as an external examiner. • You are competent, confident and creative as a teacher. • You are keen to take on new challenges, roles and responsibilities. • You actively maintain your professional development through a range of activities, and keep up-to-date with new developments, through publications, websites and teacher networks/groups.
You may have some of these needs and goals	• Maintain and refresh knowledge and expertise in a changing profession. • Develop specialist and expert knowledge and skills, e.g. by carrying out action research. • Undertake specialist advanced study, e.g. Master's degree. • Personal development (assertiveness, flexibility). • Become an advanced practitioner. • Achieve better rewards and more responsibilities.
How you progress at this stage	You may need to develop your skills in these areas: • Curriculum development. • Teacher training skills. • Coaching and mentoring skills. • Delivering workshops to colleagues. • Delivering specialist training and seminars at conferences. • Materials writing skills. • Research skills. • Examining/assessment skills. You may also need to develop other skills: • Managerial skills. • Time management. • People and team management skills. • Project management skills. Continue to contribute to blogs and ESOL groups.

Stage 5 – Advanced – demonstrating excellent teaching skills, knowledge and understanding	
Priority focus for your CPD activity at this stage	• Identify clear goals and plan your CPD towards those goals. • Undertake some classroom research. • Take more lead roles as a professional, for example, leading development sessions, speak at conferences, publish research in a journal, write an article in a peer-reviewed publication. • Shadow others in roles you would like to develop in.
Going forward	You move on to the next stage when you take on a specialist role.
Do you show these indications of development at this stage?	• You can see how new areas of responsibility positively influence teaching, e.g. mentoring improves understanding of class needs. • You enjoy the challenges of new responsibilities. • You are supportive of curriculum changes resulting from the introduction of new policies. • You want to help other teachers develop their skills. • You take on new responsibilities due to your passion for that area. • You are an inclusive expert, i.e. you use knowledge to reach out to others and not exclude them. • You are not too proud to ask for help with new responsibilities. • You recognise that there is always space for development. • You remember issues from your teaching career and use your experience to help other teachers.
Are there areas where you could improve?	Consider whether there are areas that could be improved, such as lack of confidence in taking on new responsibilities.

THE BRITISH COUNCIL'S CPD FRAMEWORK STAGE 6

Stage 6 – Specialist – leading and advising	
At this stage you will have some of these characteristics	• You may be a sector expert who advises on policy and practice • You are likely to have a specialist role, e.g. • ESOL manager • Teacher trainer • Materials developer • Test writer • Examiner • Academic/researcher • Inspector
You may have some of these needs and goals	• Undertake advanced study and research in your specialist area(s). • Publish your research and specialist articles. • Join networks in specialist areas. • Improve the standards of excellence in your organisation and your specialism.
How you progress at this stage	• Use of reflective practice will help you to develop in your current role. • Play a leading role in a teachers' association. • Work with others to present at an international conference. • Contribute to national/government research and policy. • Stay abreast of changes so that you are aware of developments in ESOL policy and funding.
Priority focus for your CPD activity at this stage	• Develop your reflective practice in your current role. • Manage a project. • Undertake research for publication. • Write an article or book. • Publish new learning and teaching materials. • Share and collaborate with your peers. • Set yourself clear targets for your development and work towards them.
Going forward	You should take a longer-term view of your development – how can you continue to develop in your current role and what new opportunities do you want to work towards?

Stage 6 – Specialist – leading and advising	
Do you show these indications of development at this stage?	• You recognise that there are stages of development within this stage, for example, you may be new to management. • You espouse a philosophy of CPD and have a reflective approach to your work. • You believe in sharing both knowledge and experience. • You are creative and thirsty for new ideas. • You seek the opinions of others and increase your personal learning network. • Other people are interested in you sharing your ideas. • You seek the opinions of others in groups/blogs.
Are there areas where you could improve?	Consider whether there are areas that could be improved, such as a reluctance to accept change.

MY CONTINUING PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT LOG



Recording your CPD is important in keeping track of the activity you carry out.

A CPD log shows that you are a reflective teacher who puts professional development at the heart of your practice. Keeping one on a regular basis also saves time, because you always have this information ready, whenever it is needed, for example:

- as evidence for your job appraisal
- if there is an inspection and evidence of CPD is asked for
- when you want to apply for a new job.

There are logs for the following activities that you can download from the English Agenda CPD portal:

<http://englishagenda.britishcouncil.org/continuing-professional-development/cpd-teacher-records>

1. Professional development courses I have attended.
2. Conferences/workshops I have attended.
3. Journal articles I have read.
4. Books I have read.
5. Internet resources I have found useful.
6. Thoughts and ideas from colleagues and peers.
7. Reflection – my thoughts and ideas on my own teaching.
8. Action research projects.
9. Talks/workshops I have given.
10. Papers/books I intend to write.

You can use these logs to record activity you've done, what you've learned and what action you intend to take. Here is an extract from a log that Patrick, a recently trained teacher, has done:

2. Conferences/workshops I have attended				
Dates	Conference/workshop title	Description/impressions	Most important things I learnt	Action I intend to take
October 2010	British Council Seminar – Using video in ELT by Jamie Keddie	I really enjoyed this – Jamie was very lively and full of good ideas.	1. I can make a video with my learners 2. New websites 3. I had an idea of using video for revision with students	1. Plan more lessons creating video with my learners 2. Spend an afternoon exploring websites, and decide which will help me best 3. Video students speaking and use it later for them to see their progress
July 2011	NATECLA annual conference, York	Great conference – I met lots of teachers and some experts!	1. Don't be afraid to talk even to well-known writers! 2. There was an interesting session on using social media and mobile technology	1. To follow an expert on Twitter 2. To read the speaker's article about social media and mobile technology

'The hallmark of a professional is their commitment to continuing professional development (CPD) for excellence, from their very first days of practising and at every stage of their career.'
(from IFL supporting professionalism, Update for 2011–14)

The British Council's Continuing Professional Development ESOL NEXUS Portal

For further support go to the ESOL NEXUS CPD portal, which has a section for managers and teachers.
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/teacher-development>

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